Lumen’s real problem is belonging.

We give every Lumenite a shared past, a shared place and a shared weekly rhythm

WHAT WE SEE

People finish work and go home alone. Gatherings are empty. Life is

“functional but empty”

WHY **No shared past** (no history)

SO the family, across time

TRADITION

The Four Letters

A shared past



- Every Lumenite writes **four letters in a life**, each at home with the household gathered, on the day they reach that age.
- Letters 1–3 **stay sealed**. At 250 you open them, read your life back, and write the fourth.
- The 250 letter is **for your children and theirs**, kept with your photo as the family’s record of who you were.
- After death, the letters go to the **Lumen Archive**, open to any future Lumenite if the writer allowed it while alive.
- In Year 1, the **~8,300 Lumenites** already past 250 write first, so history starts on day one.

Belonging: every family gains a written past, and the Archive grows into the whole planet’s shared history.

Only on Lumen: a 300-year life lets you open your own letters 225 years after the first.

WHY **No shared place** (nothing smaller than a city of 50,000 to belong to)

SO the district, once a year

FESTIVAL

The Carrying

A shared place · Day 1 of the 13th moon



- Each of the 100 districts carries **one flame to every home** it has: ~125 homes, door to door from first light.
- Every household adds what fuel it can. Fuel is **precious gas**, so each home gives part of its wealth.
- **At dusk** the flame is set in the district square for all 500 to see. It burns through the night for as long as the district’s gift lasts.

Belonging: the flame exists only because every door gave. Fire stands for hope and togetherness.

Only on Lumen: the fuel is the currency itself, and a 15-hour night gives the flame its stage.

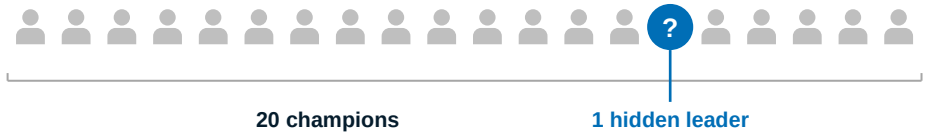
WHY **No shared rhythm** (nothing to look forward to, so work fills the time)

SO the whole planet, every week

ENTERTAINMENT

The Hidden Head League

A shared rhythm · Every week



- Each season, every district draws **20 champions by lot**; one is secretly the leader.
- Each week the districts **play in pairs (50 matches)**.
- Each round, the **hidden leader quietly steers** their side through a task; the other side watches who the players follow and names one suspect. A wrong name clears that suspect and costs the next guess; the first side to name the other’s leader wins.
- Moons 1–12 are the league; in the 13th moon the **top 16 play a knockout**, with the final on the last night of the year.
- Spectators bet in gas on the leader: **the earlier the bet, the bigger the payout** (up to 20× in round 1, falling as suspects are cleared). Stakes are capped; the house cut pays the champion district’s prize.

Belonging: a weekly reason to leave work and stand with your district. Every adult plays about 12 seasons in a life.

Only on Lumen: the planet’s real leader is secret, so its favourite game is finding one.

ONE LUMEN YEAR The 13th moon is Lumen’s high season: it opens with the Carrying (day 1) and closes with the league final (day 32).



KEY ASSUMPTIONS

1. Ages are in Lumen years (50 = Earth 18, so 25 ≈ Earth 9).
2. The moon cycle is 32 days, giving 13 moons a year (13 × 32 = 416 days). A week is 8 days, giving 52 weeks.
3. There are 100 districts of 500 people, with ~4 per home, so ~125 homes each.
4. Precious gases also burn as fuel, so fuel is money.
5. Ages are spread evenly, about 167 people per birth-year, so ~8,300 people are already past 250.
6. Open-air squares hold a whole district. The 1,000-seat Hall hosts the playoffs.
7. Betting is legal (the economy is capitalist), with a cap per person.